

MICHAEL VENUTOLO-MANTOVANI

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How to Turn Cities Into Biketopias? Make it Harder to Drive There

In New York and other cities where congestion pricing policies, bike infrastructure projects, and car bans have been put in place, cyclists are finding the streets more welcoming.

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10



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SINCE ITS IMPLEMENTATION on January 5, congestion pricing has had a major impact on New York City. Most obviously, it has eased vehicle traffic in Midtown and Lower Manhattan. It's increased foot traffic around the borough, which in turn aids the city's brick-and-mortar retailers. It's nudged people to ride the subway more, which helps reduce crime on the trains. With an average charge of \$9 per passenger car and upwards of \$21.60 for large trucks during peak hours, congestion pricing has also been a financial boon to the city, netting \$48.6 million in its first month—well above the \$40 million originally projected.

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